STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			G-4300
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 12/04/06	DATE REVISED **07/03/23**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE GENERAL	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT SHERIFF'S OFFICE VEHICLES	CROSS REFERENCE G-4310 ACCIDENTS INVOLVING COUNTY VEHICLES P-3200 PATROL UNIT P-3410 RESPONSE STATUS P-4100 PURSUITS P-5400 RIDE ALONG PROGRAM S-3210 MOBILE COMMAND CENTER			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for operating and maintaining Sheriff's Office vehicles.

II. Policy:

Employees of the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office are expected to set an example for the public in safe, lawful, and courteous driving, and shall operate vehicles in accordance with all applicable laws and policies.

III. Procedures:

A. Operation of Sheriff's Office Vehicles:

1. All employees, whether operating or a passenger in a Sheriff's Office vehicle, shall wear a seat belt (this policy applies only to those vehicles so equipped). All passengers shall also be required to wear a seat belt when being transported in a Sheriff's Office vehicle, unless specified by policy.

2. Sworn employees shall be armed with a Sheriff's Office approved firearm when operating or a passenger in a Sheriff's Office vehicle.

3. Employees whose duties include operating Sheriff's Office vehicles shall possess a valid operator's license and such license shall be always carried when so engaged.

4. Prior to operating any Sheriff's Office vehicle that is not assigned to that employee, he or she shall obtain permission from a supervisor or command

officer from the division the vehicle is assigned (e.g., a deputy must obtain permission from a road patrol supervisor or command officer prior to operating a marked patrol unit for any purpose).

5. While operating a Sheriff's Office vehicle, employees shall:

a) Comply with all traffic laws.
b) Keep windows clear of obstructions.
c) Drive in a safe and courteous manner.

6. Employee shall be aware of possible distractions while operating sheriff's office vehicles. The vehicle operator shall not send or review cellular phone text messages while the vehicle is in motion.

7. Sheriff's Office vehicles shall be secured when left unattended.

8. Sheriff's Office vehicles shall not be used for pushing, towing, or jump-starting unless specifically authorized by a supervisor or command officer.

9. Sheriff's Office vehicles shall not be utilized for personal use. Non-Sheriff's Office personnel, including family members, shall not be transported in Sheriff's Office vehicles unless for official business or under the policy provisions of the Ride Along Program (see P-5400 Ride Along Program).

10. An employee involved in an accident while operating a Sheriff's Office vehicle shall adhere to the established accident procedures (see G-4310 Accidents Involving County Vehicles).

B. Response Procedures While Operating Sheriff's Office Vehicles:

1. Felony Crimes in Progress: Sworn personnel operating Sheriff's Office vehicles may respond to felony crimes in progress. Responding personnel shall advise communications and shall be under the direction of the road patrol supervisor or command officer.

a) Marked Patrol Units: May respond adhering to established procedures (see P-3410 Response Status)

b) Unmarked Vehicles: May respond with due caution, obeying all traffic laws. Unmarked units shall not engage in vehicular pursuits (see P-3900 Pursuits).

2. Motor Vehicle Accidents: All employees operating Sheriff's Office vehicles who are involved in or observe a motor vehicle accident shall stop and render any necessary assistance.

3. Disabled Motor Vehicles: All sworn employees operating Sheriff's Office vehicles encountering an occupied disabled motor vehicle may stop and render necessary assistance. Non-sworn employees may contact Communications as soon as possible and request a marked patrol unit respond.

4. Roadside Emergencies: All sworn employees operating Sheriff's Office vehicles who are "waved down" by a citizen shall stop and render necessary assistance. Non-sworn employees shall contact Communications as soon as possible and request a marked patrol unit respond.

5. Sheriff's Office vehicles transporting inmates or enroute to an emergency call shall be exempt from rendering assistance but shall notify Communications of the location of the incident.

6. Deputies traveling in marked units outside of radio range shall use their discretion regarding assisting with disabled vehicles or other roadside emergencies. If possible, deputies shall notify a local agency by cellular phone of the disabled vehicle or roadside emergency.

C. **Sheriff's Office Vehicle Maintenance:** Employees are responsible for the maintenance and cleanliness of assigned vehicles and for vehicles they operate regardless of assignment.

1. Employees shall inspect vehicles prior to each use to ensure the vehicles are safe to operate and have no unreported damage.

a) Any missing equipment, non-functioning equipment, or unreported damage shall be immediately reported to a supervisor or command officer from the division the vehicle is assigned.

2. At no time shall any employee tamper with or alter in any manner any equipment or affect any repairs to a vehicle, unless properly authorized.

3. Employees shall ensure vehicles are fully fueled after each use.

4. Employees shall ensure vehicles are in an acceptable state of cleanliness after each use.

5. **Vehicle Maintenance Requests:**

a) If an employee identifies an equipment malfunction (e.g., radar unit, emergency lights, etc.) or a vehicle malfunction (e.g., car will not start, brakes functioning poorly, etc.), he or she shall:

(1) Notify a supervisor or command officer from the division the vehicle is assigned.

(2) Complete a Sarpy County Fleet Service Repair/Service Request Form (i.e., Vehicle Maintenance Form).

(3) Place a copy of the form on the driver's side front seat of the vehicle.

(4) The original shall be placed in the road room in-basket or forwarded to Fleet Services.

b) No Sheriff's Office vehicle shall be used if a Repair/Service Request Form has been completed for that vehicle (until the repair or service is completed).

c) When an employee's assigned vehicle is scheduled for maintenance, it shall be that employee's responsibility to ensure the vehicle is made available (either brought to the County Shops or left at the Sheriff's Office before 0700 on the date scheduled) or that prior arrangements with fleet services have been made.

D. Special Purpose Vehicles: A special purpose vehicle is a vehicle used in consideration of weather, terrain, or special operational needs.

1. Special purpose vehicles include, but are not limited to: The Emergency Service Unit (SWAT) van, The Crisis Negotiator (CNU) van, the mobile command post (see S-3210 Mobile Command Center), boats, all-terrain vehicles and trucks not assigned to the Road Patrol Division.

2. Only those personnel authorized by the Administrative Commander or authorized by a specialty unit commander responsible for the special purpose vehicle shall operate any special purpose vehicle.

3. Authorized operators shall restrict the use of special purpose vehicles to the specific intent and function for which the vehicle was designed to operate. Exceptions must be authorized by a command officer.

4. Authorized operators shall conform to all specific safety and special operating requirements for the special purpose vehicle.

5. Special Purpose Vehicle Authorized Operators:

a) The SWAT van, Sheriff Rescue Vehicle, and Polaris Ranger UTVs shall be the responsibility of the SWAT Commander. SWAT

members and designated employees may operate the SWAT van, Sheriff Rescue Vehicle, and Polaris Ranger UTVs.

b) The CNU van shall be the responsibility of the CNU Commander. CNU members and designated employees may operate the CNU van.

c) Sheriff's Office boats shall be the responsibility of the Search and Rescue Unit (SARU) Commander. Only Search and Rescue Unit members may operate boats.

d) All terrain vehicles shall be the responsibility of the Mobile Command Unit Commander. All terrain vehicles may be operated by SWAT members, Search and Rescue Unit members and those employees specifically authorized by the Administrative Commander.

e) Trucks assigned to the Administration Division shall be the responsibility of the Administrative Commander. Marine Rescue Unit members and Administrative Division sworn personnel are authorized to operate trucks assigned to the Administration Division at any time. Other employees may operate such trucks for official duties after receiving permission from the Desk Sergeant, an administrative commander, or a watch commander.